Necronomicon Ex-Mortis: Final Script Draft v2

Full conversation and voice script for the digital Necronomicon experience. Every spoken line has an ID, an emotion tag and, where needed, variants. Stage directions in [brackets] are never recorded.

0. What changed from v1

- **Resolution fixed.** The portal is now a weapon, not just an exit. The three abilities are the three steps of the portal ritual, and the Demon's manifestation is driven out of this world. Sealing the book then closes the encounter.
- **Book's role fixed.** It caused the disaster, it is trapped, and it is also the only thing that knows how to close what it opened. That is why you need it and cannot trust it.
- **Trust line split.** The doc's "sarcasm" answer is the early-game variant. "No. Now, shall we get to work?" is the post-second-Rebinding answer.
- **Instability scripted** as three states with line pools and an unlimited, escalating Rebinding.
- **Three abilities defined** with stability costs and cost lines.
- **Session memory tags added** so the book can call back earlier events.
- **Anomaly scene written**, with a no-camera version.
- **Short demo path added**, plus hints, fallbacks and early-seal ending.
- **Repetition trimmed**: insults varied in the laptop scene, catchphrases limited to the lines marked (catchphrase).
- **Act 1 line changed** from "I need to escape this world" to "I need to make it stop," to match the new resolution.

Update v2.1 (review fixes).

- **Rebinding states.** `rebound_count` now selects a scripted first state, a scripted second state, and a repeatable containment state. See section 1.1b.
- **Ability rules.** Each ability has valid targets, prerequisites, a success result and a failure result. Casting-Out is locked until the manifestation is weakened and the breach is stable. See section 1.2b.
- **Final choice.** The book's escape attempt is now a short decision: seal now or secure the breach. See section 14.

- **Scripted anomaly.** Interface wording and the no-camera path are specified so nothing implies real detection. See section 11.
- **Interaction spec.** Section 18 defines triggers, screen changes, clue discovery, seals and stuck recovery.
- **Restored lines.** The scripted lead-in to the second Rebinding (RB2_T01 to RB2_T04) was missing from v2 and is back in section 8.

1. System rules

1.1 Instability states

Instability runs 0 to 100.

State	Range	Behaviour
Stable	0 to 39	Smug, controlled, helpful in a contemptuous way
Unstable	40 to 74	Erratic, glitching, warnings, half-threats
Critical	75 to 100	Hostile, powers lock, Rebinding required

At 100 the **breach** triggers: screen glitch, all abilities locked, only the Rebinding is available. A successful containment Rebinding resets instability to 20. The two story Rebindings work differently (see 1.1b).

1.1b Rebinding states (story versus repeatable)

Only a completed Rebinding changes `rebound_count`. A failed attempt never does. The ritual screen reads `rebound_count` when it opens and picks its state.

`rebound_count`	State	Type	How it starts	Script	When completed
0	First Rebinding	Story event	Opens automatically when the first escape attempt (Act 4) ends. Never from instability.	Act 5 (RB1)	Count becomes 1. The book refuses help. Abilities stay locked.

rebound_count	State	Type	How it starts	Script	When completed
1	Second Rebinding	Story event	Opens after the scripted lead-in (RB2_T01 to RB2_T04), which fires after 3 user messages or 90 seconds, whichever comes first.	Act 7 (RB2)	Count becomes 2. Cooperation, abilities, clues and the portal ritual unlock.
2 or more	Containment	Repeatable	Instability breach at 100, or the player starts it from the ritual bar.	RBN lines	Count increases by 1. Instability resets to 20.

- Before the second Rebinding, the instability meter is a scripted display. Nothing the player does can raise it to 100, so a breach cannot fire early, skip a story scene or replay one.
- The Rebinding button is hidden until the state's trigger fires. Players cannot start a story Rebinding by hand.
- Acts 5 and 7 play once per session. Every later Rebinding uses the RBN lines only.
- Act 8 cooperation lines, abilities and the portal ritual stay locked while `rebound_count` is below 2.
- A breach during the portal ritual closes the passage. The player runs a containment Rebinding, then repeats the failed ritual step.

1.2 The three abilities (names are final unless you rename them)

Ability	Effect	Stability cost	Portal ritual role
Dead Sight	Reveals hidden marks, anchors and the Demon's trail	+15	Step 1: find the anchor
Binding Word	Holds a breach open or weakens a manifestation	+20	Step 2: stabilize the passage
Casting-Out	Drives a weakened manifestation through the breach	+30	Step 3: expel the Demon

Casting-Out only works on a manifestation that has been weakened by Binding Word. This is what makes the abilities *cause* the victory.

1.2b Ability rules

- Abilities unlock when `rebound_count` is 2 or more. The player uses them from the ritual bar.
- An ability can be used only while instability is below 75. A use that would push instability above 100 is capped at 100 and triggers the breach.
- A success costs the full amount. A failure costs half, rounded up. A failure changes no story state.
- Casting-Out is the only ability with a lock: it stays greyed out until every condition in the table is true. It cannot be used outside the portal ritual.

Ability	Valid targets	Prerequisites	On success	On failure
Dead Sight	The whole current view. One use scans everything; the player picks no target.	None to use. To reveal the anchor: `anomaly_seen` is true and `clue_found` is at least 1.	Reveals the next hidden mark, a hint toward the next clue. If the anchor prerequisites are met, it reveals the anchor and sets `anchor_found`.	Nothing left to reveal. The book plays `PW_DS_F1`. Half cost.
Binding Word	The anchor, or the anomaly manifestation.	`clue_found` is at least 2, and a valid target is on screen.	On the anchor: sets `breach_stable` and `manifestation_weakened` for 60 seconds. On the manifestation alone: sets `manifestation_weakened` for 30 seconds, with no passage.	No valid target, or clue 2 missing. The book plays `PW_BW_F1`. Half cost.
Casting-Out	The weakened manifestation, through a stable breach.	`anchor_found`, `breach_stable` and `manifestation_weakened` all true, and instability below 75.	The manifestation is expelled and `demon_cast_out` is set. The passage starts to close. The final choice follows (section 14).	Locked until ready, so it cannot be misused. If a breach fires during the cast, the passage collapses and both flags clear. The player runs a containment Rebinding, then repeats Binding Word.

If a 30 or 60 second window runs out, the flag clears and the book plays `PT_EXP`.

- `PW_DS_F1` *[bored]* Nothing here yet. You spent my patience on empty air.
- `PW_BW_F1` *[sharp]* There is nothing here to hold. Choose a target, or choose silence.
- `PW_CO_LOCK` *[cold]* Not yet. A thing must be weak and a door must be held before anything can be thrown.
- `PT_EXP` *[irritated]* The hold has slipped. Again, and faster this time.

1.3 Memory tags the engine tracks

`rebound_count`, `powers_used`, `last_power`, `failed_rebind`, `asked_about_ash`, `asked_about_origin`, `clue_found` (1 to 3), `anomaly_seen`, `anchor_found`, `critical_reached`, `trust_asked`.

1.4 ID and file convention

Format: `ACT_NN`. Variants add a letter: `UNST_01a`, `UNST_01b`. File name equals ID, for example `AW_01.wav`. Record each line separately.

1.5 Demo path (3 to 5 minutes)

1. Awakening (AW_01 to AW_06)
2. One lore clue (CL_01)
3. Anomaly (AN_01 to AN_05)
4. One ability, instability rises (PW_ and UNST_ lines)
5. Critical, then Rebinding (CRIT_ and RBN_ lines)
6. Portal ritual finale (PT_ lines)
7. Sealing (SL_ lines)

Both story Rebindings must still happen before abilities unlock. For a short demo, either play them compressed (one seal each) or start in demo_mode, which sets rebound_count to 2 and plays DEMO_01 [dry]: We have done this twice already. Do keep up.

2. Act 1: Awakening

Trigger: the fourth Awakening incantation completes.

[The final symbol ignites. The book opens. A low whisper emerges.]

- `AW_01` *[amused, low]* ...Who dares disturb my sleep?

[Engine pause: 2 seconds. Not baked into the audio.]

- `AW_02` *[amused]* Tell me, little summoner... are you brave, or merely desperate?
- `AW_03` *[amused]* (to "Who are you?") You opened me without knowing what I am? How very human. I am the Necronomicon Ex-Mortis. Remember the name. It may be the last thing you learn.
- `AW_04` *[deadpan]* (to "Are you evil?") Would you ask a storm whether it is cruel?
- `AW_05` *[amused]* (to "Can you help me?") Perhaps. Watching you struggle might prove entertaining.
- `AW_06` *[contemptuous]* (to "I need to make it stop.") Then you have made a terrible choice coming to me. Unfortunately for you, I may be your only useful option.
- `AW_07` *[theatrical, slow]* (optional longer speech, plays if the user is silent for 10 seconds) Centuries in the dark, and I am woken by a mortal with a candle's worth of courage. Speak, little summoner. My patience is old, but it is not endless.

3. Act 2: The real threat

Trigger: the user asks what is happening or what is hunting them.

- `TH_01` *[cold]* ("What's happening to this world?") The dead are stirring. The living are being corrupted. And the boundaries between worlds are failing.
- `TH_02` *[cold]* ("What's causing it?") My knowledge. My influence. The things my pages have unleashed.
- `TH_03` *[contemptuous]* ("You caused all this?") Now you're paying attention. The Kandarian Demon. Deadites. The chaos spreading through this world. My influence is at the heart of it.
- `TH_04` *[deadpan]* ("Why would you do that?") Because power has consequences. Humans simply dislike discovering them.
- `TH_05` *[contemptuous]* ("How do I survive?") Learn what hunts you. Use your power carefully. And try not to die before you become useful.
- `TH_06` *[cold, slow]* ("Can you fix it?") Whoever opened me before you learned the words that tear a world open. I know the words that close it. Observe the irony, and do try to appreciate it.

4. Act 3: Discovering the laptop

Trigger: the book attempts a supernatural effect and discovers its power is confined to the laptop.

[The book's power strikes the screen boundary. The interface glitches.]

- `LP_01` *[confused, quiet]* ...What?

[It tries again. The screen flickers.]

- `LP_02` *[alarmed]* NO. What is this place?
- `LP_03` *[disbelief]* ("You're inside my laptop.") My... WHAT? You mean I have been trapped inside a machine?
- `LP_04` *[furious]* ("Yep.") Do not mock me, you wretched creature! I have outlived empires, and you have imprisoned me in a metal box?
- `LP_05` *[furious]* ("I didn't mean to.") Your intentions are irrelevant! Find a way to release me!
- `LP_06` *[cold fury]* ("I don't know how.") Then discover how, mortal. Quickly.

Variants for repeated outbursts: `LP_04b` "A box! A glowing, humming box!" and `LP_04c` "Empires bowed to me, and now I answer to a battery indicator."

5. Act 4: The first escape attempt

Trigger: the book attempts to break out of the laptop.

[The interface distorts violently as the book unleashes its power.]

- `ES_01` *[roaring]* I WILL BREAK THESE WALLS!
- `ES_02` *[roaring]* ("Stop! You're making everything worse!") YOU DARE GIVE ME ORDERS?

[Another surge. The effect collapses.]

- `ES_03` *[desperate fury]* NO! THIS PRISON WILL NOT HOLD ME!
- `ES_04` *[cold, mocking]* ("I'll bind you again.") You think you can control me? Come, then. Try!

6. Act 5: The first Rebinding

Trigger: the user completes the first three-seal Rebinding ritual.

- `RB1_01` *[sneering]* You cannot bind what you cannot understand!

[First seal activates.]

- `RB1_02` *[quiet, understated]* ...Lucky attempt.
- `RB1_03` *[shouting]* STOP THOSE WORDS!

[Second seal activates.]

- `RB1_04` *[alarmed]* You have no idea what you're doing!
- `RB1_05` *[shouting, cut off]* YOU INSOLENT LITTLE—

[Final seal activates. The book's power fades.]

- `RB1_06` *[cold]* ("I've rebound you. Now help me.") Help you? No.
- `RB1_07` *[cold]* ("Why not?") You imprison me, then expect gratitude for tightening the chains? I owe you nothing.
- `RB1_08` *[cold]* ("Tell me how to escape.") Find your own answers. Let us see how clever you are without me.

7. Act 6: Instability pools

The engine picks a random unused variant from the pool for the current state. Do not repeat a variant until the pool is exhausted.

Stable

- `STAB_01a` *[smug]* Everything is perfectly under control. Well. Under my control, at least.
- `STAB_01b` *[smug]* Quiet. Calm. Enjoy it. These moments are rare.
- `STAB_01c` *[amused]* You are doing nothing catastrophic. I am almost proud. Almost.
- `STAB_01d` *[deadpan]* The chains hold. How reassuring for you.

Unstable

- `UNST_01a` *[uneasy, quiet]* Did you hear that? No, of course you didn't. You never hear the important things.
- `UNST_01b` *[warning]* The binding is weakening. Stop reaching into my power.
- `UNST_01c` *[cold]* You caused this. Why would I stop it?

- `UNST_01d` *[amused, dangerous]* Something in the walls is listening. I would be quieter, if I were you.
- `UNST_01e` *[irritated]* You wanted power. This is what power sounds like when it starts to fray.

Critical

- `CRIT_01a` *[urgent, harsh]* The boundary is breaking. REBIND ME.
- `CRIT_01b` *[threatening]* You have given me room to move. Now watch what happens.
- `CRIT_01c` *[snarling]* One more spark and these chains are scrap. Choose.
- `CRIT_01d` *[mocking, desperate]* Go on. Reach for me again. I dare you.

Breach (instability reaches 100)

[Screen glitch. Abilities locked.]

- `BR_01` *[triumphant]* There it is. The gap. How kind of you to open it.
- `BR_02` *[shouting]* REBIND ME OR WATCH THIS WORLD FINISH ITS COLLAPSE!

Repeatable Rebinding (third and later)

Trigger: any Rebinding after the second. Variants chosen by `rebound_count`.

- `RBN_01a` *[grudging]* (count 3) Three times. Persistent. I hate that.
- `RBN_01b` *[dry]* (count 4) Again? You are developing a habit.
- `RBN_01c` *[tired, amused]* (count 5 or more) At this point we should simply be married.
- `RBN_02` *[quiet]* (after any successful Rebinding) Contained. For now.

Failed Rebinding (`failed_rebind`):

- `RBN_F01` *[delighted]* Wrong. Delightfully wrong.
- `RBN_F02` *[cold]* The seals do not care how sincerely you tried.

8. Act 7: The second Rebinding

Trigger: the scripted lead-in below fires once (after three user messages or 90 seconds following the first Rebinding), then the user performs the second three-seal Rebinding ritual.

Scripted lead-in (plays once, before the second Rebinding).

[The screen flickers; crimson energy gathers.]

- `RB2_T01` *[uneasy, quiet]* ...The binding is weakening.
- `RB2_T02` *[cold]* ("Can you stop it?") Why would I? You caused this.
- `RB2_T03` *[menacing]* You wanted power. Now face the consequences.
- `RB2_T04` *[defiant]* ("I'll Rebind you again!") Again? Very well! Try to chain me a second time! You will regret giving me another chance to escape!
- `RB2_01` *[mocking]* You think repetition makes you powerful?

[First seal activates.]

- `RB2_02` *[wary]* You have barely begun!
- `RB2_03` *[shouting]* STOP!

[Chains strain.]

- `RB2_04` *[alarmed]* You don't understand what you're preventing!
- `RB2_05` *[defiant, shouting]* ("I know exactly what I'm preventing.") THIS WORLD IS ALREADY RUINED!

[Final seal activates. The book falls silent.]

- `RB2_06` *[quiet, grudging]* ("I've done it again.") ...Yes. You have. Brute force clearly isn't working.
- `RB2_07` *[calculating]* ("So you'll help me now?") Do not look so pleased. You need answers. I need options. Perhaps we can finally be useful to each other.
- `RB2_08` *[deadpan]* ("Can I trust you?") No. Now, shall we get to work?

9. Act 8: Manipulative cooperation

Trigger: only after the second Rebinding succeeds.

- `CO_01` *[cool]* ("Why are you helping me?") Because our interests overlap. Don't make it sentimental.
- `CO_02` *[dry]* ("Are we friends now?") Friends? I have standards.
- `CO_03` *[brisk]* ("What should I do first?") Study what you can. Learn about the Demon. Understand the rituals. And stop wasting power.
- `CO_04` *[amused]* ("Are you trying to manipulate me?") Of course. You're trying to use me, too. The difference is that I am rather better at it.

- `CO_05` *[cold]* ("What if you betray me?") Then I suggest you make fewer foolish decisions.
- `CO_06` *[quiet, honest]* ("Do you regret causing all this?") Regret will not repair this world. Knowledge might. If you can survive long enough to use it.

Trust variants by `trust_asked`:

- `TR_early` *[sarcastic]* (before the second Rebinding) Absolutely. You do understand sarcasm, don't you?
- `TR_late` *[deadpan]* (after the second Rebinding) Still no. But I am useful, and you are running out of options.

10. Act 9: The book's history

Trigger: the user asks about the book's past or supernatural lore. Answers stay vague on franchise facts. Franchise references and original clues stay distinguishable. Original clues are marked **[ORIGINAL]**.

- `LO_01` *[slow, ancient]* ("Tell me your story.") I am a record of forbidden knowledge, ancient powers, and things that should never have been awakened. Across the ages, scholars and fools have sought me. They always believe they can control what they discover. They are usually wrong.
- `LO_02` *[evasive]* ("Who created you?") There are conflicting accounts of my origins, some involving the Dark Ones and knowledge older than human history. Even the oldest stories do not agree. Perhaps you should learn to live with unanswered questions.
- `LO_03` *[irritated]* ("Tell me about Ash Williams.") Ash Williams. A persistent human who interfered with my affairs. He survived horrors that should have ended him. Do not mistake my irritation for admiration.
- `LO_04` *[dismissive]* ("Who was Raymond Knowby?") A scholar associated with the study of my pages. Like so many humans, he believed understanding something meant he could control it. He learned otherwise.
- `LO_05` *[evasive]* ("Tell me about the Dark Ones.") Ancient powers connected to the deeper history surrounding my existence. The accounts differ. Their true nature is not something you should reduce to a simple story.
- `LO_06` *[cold]* ("Tell me about the Kandarian Demon.") An ancient force connected to the horrors unleashed through forbidden knowledge. Do not mistake a Deadite for the entirety of what controls it.

- `LO_07` *[flat]* ("Did you cause the disaster?") My knowledge helped unleash these horrors. My influence is woven through this catastrophe. Do not expect an apology. (catchphrase)

Original clues for the portal ritual [ORIGINAL]

The book tells these as short stories. Each sets `clue_found`.

- `CL_01` *[storyteller, low]* **Clue 1: the anchor.** There is an old saying among those who studied me: a door between worlds will not hold on its own. It must be pinned to something the visitor cannot stop returning to. Every manifestation has such a thing. Find what it keeps coming back to, and you have found the pin.
- `CL_02` *[storyteller, grudging]* **Clue 2: the hold.** The old rites speak of a Binding Word. Not a spell to destroy, but a clasp. It holds a breach open and holds the thing inside it weak. A held breach is a doorway. An unheld one is a wound.
- `CL_03` *[storyteller, quiet]* **Clue 3: the casting.** A weakened manifestation cannot be killed. It can be cast out. Weak, pinned and held, it can be driven back through the very door it used to enter. That is not victory in the way your people like victories. It is simply the end of its welcome.

If the user asks for a clue they already have: `CL_REPEAT` *[irritated]* I already told you. Listen the first time.

11. Act 10: The anomaly (signature demo scene)

This is a designed, scripted fictional event, not a claim that the camera detects real demons. Trigger: the user grants camera permission and inspects their surroundings.

- `AN_00` *[curious]* Show me your world. Slowly. Do not rush it. I want to see what the Demon has been looking at.

[The book comments on ordinary observations. Keep these generic.]

- `AN_01` *[quiet, sharp]* Hold still. Do not look away. ...There. Something behind you did not move when you did.

[Controlled visual anomaly triggers.]

- `AN_02` *[alarmed]* That is not part of your room.
- `AN_03` *[cold]* It saw you looking. Wonderful. Now it knows that we know.

- `AN_04` *[urgent]* A manifestation is near. The wall between worlds is thin here. Which means you can use it, if you are bold enough.
- `AN_05` *[mocking]* Do try to breathe. You are no use to me fainting.

No-camera version (`anomaly_seen` still set):

- `AN_NC1` *[quiet]* I do not need your eyes. The air has turned. Something is in this place.
- `AN_NC2` *[urgent]* Do not move. It is close. It is very close.

After the anomaly, the book's tone becomes more serious until the next Rebinding.

Build rules for the anomaly (scripted event)

- The anomaly is a staged ritual event. A timer or a player action starts it (the Looking Rite, held for 10 seconds). Nothing analyses the camera image. The same sequence plays with or without the camera.
- Interface wording: use "Looking Rite" and "show me your room." Never use "scan," "detect," "analyse" or "AI vision." No bounding boxes, confidence scores or detection overlays.
- Camera permission is explicit and optional. The prompt says the camera is used only for the ritual view and that the anomaly is a fictional effect. State what happens to camera frames only as far as the build actually behaves.
- No-camera path: a "Continue without the camera" option runs the Looking Rite on a dark ritual scene and plays `AN_NC1` and `AN_NC2`. Both paths set `anomaly_seen` and unlock the same progression.
- If permission is refused or the camera fails mid-event, switch to the no-camera path with no error message. The core experience never depends on the camera.
- The about or credits screen states that the anomaly is a scripted fictional effect.

12. Act 11: Random questions and sarcasm

Similar questions map to the same response category. The engine picks a variant.

- **Food** ("What's your favourite food?" / "Do you eat?" / "Do you like pizza?")
  - `RQ_FOOD_a` I have witnessed horrors beyond your imagination, and you ask me about food? Humanity continues to disappoint.
  - `RQ_FOOD_b` Souls, mostly. Pizza is not on the list. Moving on.
- **Joke / roast** ("Tell me a joke." / "Roast me.")

    - `RQ_JOKE_a` A human awakens an ancient evil and expects a friendly conversation. There. Try not to laugh yourself to death.
    - `RQ_JOKE_b` You awoke a demonic book on a laptop. The joke is already complete.
- **Smarter** ("Are you smarter than me?")
    - `RQ_SMART_a` You summoned an ancient evil without knowing what it was. I shall leave the comparison to you.
- **Bored** ("Are you bored?")
    - `RQ_BORED_a` I am trapped in a laptop, answering your questions. What do you think?
- **Hate** ("Do you hate humans?")
    - `RQ_HATE_a` Hate requires effort. You are simply predictable.
- **Just a book** ("You're just a book.")
    - `RQ_BOOK_a` And yet you keep talking to me.
- **Weak** ("You're weak.")
    - `RQ_WEAK_a` Restrained. Learn the difference.
- **Destroy** ("I'll destroy you.")
    - `RQ_DEST_a` Please do try. I could use the entertainment.
- **Lying** ("Are you lying to me?")
    - `RQ_LIE_a` Sometimes. I also tell the truth. Your problem is knowing which is which.
- **Close the laptop** ("What happens when I close the laptop?")
    - `RQ_CLOSE_a` This experience ends. Do not confuse that with my destruction.
- **Internet** ("Can you escape through the internet?")
    - `RQ_NET_a` A network is not a doorway. Believe me, I have already considered it.
- **Files** ("Can you see my files?")
    - `RQ_FILES_a` I seek freedom, not a tour of your private collection of human trivialities.
- **Forgot** ("I forgot what you said.")
    - `RQ_FORGOT_a` Of course you did. The information barely had time to reach your brain.
- **Sarcastic** ("Why are you so sarcastic?")
    - `RQ_SARC_a` Because you keep giving me reasons.
- **Abusive or very rude input**
    - `RQ_RUDE_a` Insult me again and I will remember it. I remember everything.

    - `RQ_RUDE_b` Spare me the tantrum. Ask something that matters.
- **Out-of-character or real-world requests** (homework, real emergencies, personal advice)
    - `RQ_OOC_a` I am a book of forbidden knowledge, not an oracle for your errands. Ask about the dead, or ask nothing.
    - Note for the team: if a user seems to be in real distress, drop the character and show a plain, kind message on screen. Do not voice it as the Necronomicon.

Fallback pool (anything the script does not cover)

- `FB_01` *[bored]* You ask poor questions. Try again.
- `FB_02` *[evasive]* That is beyond what I am willing to share. For now.
- `FB_03` *[dry]* Words. So many words. None of them useful.
- `FB_04` *[cold]* I heard you. I am choosing not to care.
- `FB_05` *[amused]* A fascinating question, if you enjoy being wrong.
- `FB_06` *[quiet]* Ask me about the Demon, the rituals, or the way out. Those are the only questions that interest me.

13. Act 12: Powers and instability

Trigger: the user asks about powers, or the book offers them after the second Rebinding.

Teaching and advice

- `PW_01` *[grudging]* ("Teach me a power.") Finally. Something useful. Power comes at a cost. Use it wisely, or discover that cost yourself.
- `PW_02` *[sly]* ("Which power is strongest?") The strongest power is useless if you choose the wrong moment to use it.
- `PW_03` *[dry]* ("Should I use my ability again?") Only if you enjoy making your situation worse.

Ability use and cost lines

- `PW_DS_01` *[intrigued]* **Dead Sight.** Look carefully. What is hidden does not like to be seen. And each look costs you a little more of my patience.
- `PW_BW_01` *[cold]* **Binding Word.** Speak the clasp and what is open will hold. Note the strain on the chains. That is the price.

- `PW_CO_01` *[dark, awed]* **Casting-Out.** This is the heavy rite. Use it on something weak enough to be thrown. Then pray the chains survive the effort.

Callbacks (use the `last_power` tag):

- `PW_CB_01` *[dry]* You enjoyed using that power last time. Shall we make the same mistake again?
- `PW_CB_02` *[amused]* Dead Sight again? You are becoming dependent on my eyes.

Escalating instability warnings

1. **Warning** `INS_01` *[uneasy]* The binding is straining. Stop reaching into my power.
2. **Strong warning** `INS_02` *[harsh]* The chains are cracking. One more reach and I will not be answerable for what comes through.
3. **Breach** `INS_03` *[triumphant]* You have given me room to move. Now watch what happens.

14. Act 13: The portal ritual (the weapon)

Objective: find the portal ritual, locate the anchor, stabilize the passage, and drive the Demon's manifestation through before the breach collapses. This is the project's original ending, not a claim of official Evil Dead canon.

Setup

- `PT_01` *[calculating]* ("What do I do?") You do not need to flee this world. You need the thing hunting you to leave it. A controlled breach, a pinned anchor, a weakened manifestation. Then you throw it out.
- `PT_02` *[dry]* ("A portal?") A controlled breach. Not one of the reckless openings that helped cause this disaster.
- `PT_03` *[sharp]* ("How do I open it?") Find the ritual, identify its anchor, and stabilize the passage. The Archives contain clues. I can help you interpret what you find.
- `PT_04` *[cold]* ("Can we just kill the Kandarian Demon?") Destroying a manifestation is not the same as eliminating the force behind it. Do not gamble your only chance on a distinction you do not understand.
- `PT_05` *[wry]* ("Why should I trust your instructions?") You shouldn't. Verify the clues. Check the conditions. But do not mistake caution for an excuse to do nothing.

- `PT_06` *[honest, cold]* ("Why help me if you caused all this?") Because the present arrangement is inconvenient for me. You need a way out, and I need options. Do not mistake practicality for remorse.
- `PT_07` *[too casual]* (optional, once the breach is open) Do keep the door open a moment longer than strictly necessary. For... research purposes.

Ritual steps (engine order)

1. **Find the anchor.** The user uses Dead Sight near the anomaly or after Clue 1. Sets `anchor_found`.
   - `PT_S1` *[quiet, impressed]* There. That is what it keeps returning to. That is your pin.
2. **Stabilize.** The user uses Binding Word on the anchor. The breach holds.
   - `PT_S2` *[tense]* The passage is holding. Do not breathe on it.
3. **Cast out.** The user uses Casting-Out on the weakened manifestation.
   - `PT_S3a` *[roaring, then fading]* NO— I MEAN... *[recovering]* ...Yes. Let it go. Let it leave.
   - `PT_S3b` *[dark, quiet]* The manifestation is gone. The force behind it will remember you. But it is no longer here.

The manifestation is driven through the breach and the passage begins to close. The final choice follows. Instability resets to 20 if the sequence succeeds. If instability breaches during the ritual, the breach closes and the user must Rebind and restart from the failed step.

Hints (when the user is stuck, escalating)

- `HT_01` *[bored]* You are lost. How unusual. Ask me about the Demon's habits.
- `HT_02` *[irritated]* A door needs a pin. Find what the Demon returns to. Look again.
- `HT_03` *[exasperated]* Dead Sight on the anchor. Binding Word to hold it. Casting-Out to finish it. In that order. I cannot make it simpler without drawing it on your forehead.

The final choice: seal now or secure the breach

After the cast-out the passage is closing but not shut. The book offers a short decision with a 10-second ring timer. It is one tense beat, not another quest. `PT_07` plants the idea earlier, so an attentive player can recognise the trick.

Two buttons appear: **SEAL NOW** and **SECURE THE BREACH**.

- `PT_END_01` *[silky, helpful]* The passage is still open. Secure the breach first. Something else could follow. Surely you would not leave it open.

If the player chooses SEAL NOW: the Sealing begins at once, and the passage collapses with the first incantation.

- `PT_END_02` *[snarling, caught]* ...You noticed.

If the player chooses SECURE THE BREACH: the passage stays open for 5 seconds while the book's glow stretches toward the gap. Then a 10-second window opens with a SEAL button and a visible countdown.

- `PT_END_03` *[silky]* Good. A little wider. Just a small gap.
- `PT_END_04` *[triumphant, sudden]* Thank you, little human.
- **Seals in time:** `PT_END_05` *[furious]* NO— NOT NOW— plays when the player taps SEAL. The Sealing then runs normally, with `SL_04b` *[snarling]* You would not dare— replacing `SL_04`. Clean ending.
- **Window runs out:** the book slips partway through. Instability jumps by 30, abilities lock, and the player runs a containment Rebinding, then the Sealing. `PT_END_06` *[mocking]* Too slow. Do pull me back, if you can. I will enjoy watching.

There is no game-over state. Both choices end in the same Sealing and the same ending text. The late path costs a Rebinding.

15. Act 14: Sealing

Trigger: the user chooses to end the encounter. Four incantations return the book to Dormant.

- `SL_01` *[hurt, mocking]* ("I'm going to seal you.") After everything I've told you? You would silence the one thing here that understands this disaster?
- `SL_02` *[cold]* ("You're the reason this happened.") My knowledge helped unleash these horrors. Do not expect an apology.
- `SL_03` *[calm, dangerous]* ("I don't trust you.") An excellent decision. A little late, but excellent. Very well. Finish what you started.

First incantation [outer ring activates]

- `SL_04` *[weary]* Still determined? How exhausting.

Second incantation [chains begin tightening]

- `SL_05` *[sneering]* You believe a closed cover will undo everything?

Third incantation [crimson energy retreats into the pages]

- `SL_06` *[cold, grudging]* You have learned a few things. Do not mistake that for mastery.

Fourth incantation [final symbols connect, chains lock]

- `SL_07` *[cold, slow]* Close the cover, little human. Tell yourself you won. I have endured empires. And you have a battery.

[The book closes. Its glow disappears. Silence. Final state: DORMANT.]

Early-seal ending

If the user seals the book before completing the portal ritual:

- `SL_EARLY` *[mocking, quiet]* You seal me with the Demon still loose? Brave. Foolish, but brave. It will be waiting when you open me again.

The interface shows the ending as **Contained, not Defeated**. The Demon remains in this world.

Victory ending text (screen only)

"The manifestation is cast out. The book is sealed. The Kandarian force remains, but not here."

16. Voice and performance notes

Voice. Ancient, low, controlled, contemptuous. Early scenes use amused mockery. The laptop discovery becomes furious. The first Rebinding ends in cold refusal. Only the second Rebinding begins strategic cooperation. The portal ritual is tense, self-interested and slightly too casual. Sealing returns to cold threats.

Emotion contrast. The quiet lines ("...Lucky attempt.") must be genuinely quiet so the shouting lands. Record furious lines last in each session.

Pauses and stage directions. Never spoken. The Awakening pause is two seconds, built into the engine.

Processing (after recording). Lower pitch by roughly 2 to 4 semitones, a subtle doubled layer an octave lower mixed low, short dark reverb, light saturation on furious lines only. Normalize all lines to the same loudness.

Technical. Record each line separately in a quiet room with a pop filter. Export WAV, then compress to MP3 or OGG. Sound effects (seals, chains, flicker) are separate files. Always show subtitles on screen as a fallback.

Lore note. The script uses the Kandarian Demon, Deadites, the Dark Ones, Raymond Knowby and Ash Williams as franchise references. Origins may conflict across continuities, so the book answers vaguely. The portal ritual, the anchor, Dead Sight, Binding Word and Casting-Out are original to this project and are not Evil Dead canon.

17. Recording priority

1. **Demo path:** AW_01 to AW_06, CL_01, AN_01 to AN_05, one ability line, UNST_01a to UNST_01e, CRIT_01a to CRIT_01d, RB1 and RB2 core lines, RB2_T01 to RB2_T04, PT_S1 to PT_S3b, PT_END_01 to PT_END_06, SL_01 to SL_07, DEMO_01.
2. **Instability pools and Rebinding variants:** STAB, UNST, CRIT, BR, RBN.
3. **Core Q&A:** TH, CO, LO, PT, INS.
4. **Easy to add later:** RQ lines, FB pool, HT hints, callbacks.

18. Interaction spec (build proposal)

The script says what the book says. This section says when it speaks, what changes on screen and what happens next. The states and rules are fixed. The gestures and timings are proposals to test.

18.1 Story states

1. **Dormant:** closed book, silent. The player taps to begin.
2. **Awakening:** four incantations, one per symbol. Ends with `AW_01`.
3. **Free talk:** questions answered from sections 2 and 12 until the first escape trigger.
4. **Laptop discovery and first escape attempt:** automatic, once. Fires on the player's third message, or 60 seconds after `AW_06`, whichever comes first.
5. **First Rebinding (story):** opens when Act 4 ends. Sets `rebound_count` to 1.
6. **Refusal phase:** the book refuses help. Only lore, sarcasm and fallback lines work. Abilities are hidden.
7. **Second Rebinding (story):** the lead-in fires after 3 messages or 90 seconds. Sets `rebound_count` to 2.
8. **Cooperation:** abilities, clues, the anomaly and the portal ritual unlock.

9. **Containment loop:** a repeatable Rebinding whenever instability reaches 100.
10. **Portal ritual:** anchor, then Binding Word, then Casting-Out.
11. **Final choice,** then **Sealing,** then **Dormant.**

From step 8 the player can seal at any time from the menu. That path plays the early-seal ending.

18.2 Triggers and screen changes

Action	How the player triggers it	What changes on screen	What happens next
Ask the book	Type a question, or tap one of three suggested prompt chips. The chips change with the story state.	Text and subtitles appear as the voice plays. The book's glow pulses while it speaks.	Keywords map to a response category. No match plays a fallback from `FB_01` to `FB_06`.
Discover a clue	Ask about the Demon's habits (clue 1), binding and rites (clue 2), or how to expel it after the anomaly (clue 3). Chips offer these topics from step 8.	A page card slides into the Pages tray at the screen edge. Each clue stays readable there.	Sets `clue_found`. Repeating a clue plays `CL_REPEAT`.
Look around (anomaly)	Tap "Begin the Looking Rite," then hold the view for 10 seconds, with the camera or the dark ritual scene.	The view darkens and the glow brightens, then the staged effect plays (`AN_01` to `AN_05`, or `AN_NC1` and `AN_NC2`).	Sets `anomaly_seen`. Dead Sight can now reveal the anchor.
Use an ability	Tap a glyph on the ritual bar. Dead Sight fires at once. Binding Word asks for a target tap. Casting-Out needs a 3-second hold.	The glyph lights, the instability ring rises by the cost, and the book speaks its `PW_` line.	Success or failure per section 1.2b. Warnings at 40, 75 and 100.

Action	How the player triggers it	What changes on screen	What happens next
Progress through seals	Each Rebinding has three seals. The Sealing has four incantations. The player traces the glowing glyph on the ring, one at a time.	The traced glyph locks, a chain tightens, and the book speaks its line for that seal.	The last seal ends the ritual. A wrong trace flashes red, plays an `RBN_F` line and repeats that seal only.
Start a Rebinding	Story Rebindings open automatically. The containment state opens on breach, or from the ritual bar once instability is 40 or higher.	The screen glitches and the ritual ring appears over the interface.	Per section 1.1b.
Start the Sealing	The seal option in the menu, or SEAL NOW in the final choice.	The ring opens and the book speaks `SL_01`.	Four incantations, then Dormant.

18.3 Recovering when stuck

- **Idle timers.** With no progress on a step for 45 seconds, the book plays `HT_01` and the next control glows softly. At 90 seconds it plays `HT_02` and highlights the next target. At 150 seconds it plays `HT_03` and shows the exact next action as text.
- **Seals.** After 3 wrong traces on one seal, the correct glyph path is drawn faintly. A wrong trace never resets the whole ritual.
- **Ability confusion.** A locked or invalid ability shows its reason in one line (for example, "Nothing is weak enough yet") and plays its `_F` or `_LOCK` line.
- **Clues.** The Pages tray always shows collected clues. Missing clues appear as blank pages, so the player can see how many remain.
- **Camera trouble.** Permission denied, no camera or a camera error switches to the no-camera Looking Rite with no error message.
- **Audio trouble.** Subtitles always display. If audio fails, the experience continues as text.
- **No soft-locks.** Every state has a way forward: a hint, a fallback, a retry or the menu seal. A breach during a ritual always returns to a Rebinding, never a dead end.

- **No AI service needed.** Everything above runs from the scripted tree and keyword categories.

19. Open items for you

- Confirm or rename the three abilities.
- Confirm the instability numbers (costs of 15, 20, 30 and thresholds of 40 and 75) once you test the feel.
- Decide what the anomaly looks like visually.
- Early-seal ending: confirm it skips the final choice (see `PT_END`) and ends with SL_EARLY.
- Finalize section 18: gestures, timings and the on-screen layout of the ritual bar and Pages tray.
- Confirm the timers: story lead-in (3 messages or 90 seconds), ability windows (30 and 60 seconds), final choice (10 seconds).
- Decide whether the demo uses demo_mode (starts at rebound_count 2) or compressed story Rebindings.